

SHRIYA PATIL



HEROES: Grand welcome for T20 champs, (below) hockey team after Asia Cup win

“The cricketers deserve the cash awards, no doubt, but should not hockey players be treated in the same manner?”

JOAQUIM CARVALHO HOCKEY COACH



REUTERS

The roads of Mumbai swarmed with media and fans, the sponsors Sahara group gifted homes, BCCI announced rewards as did ministers and corporate houses. India's hockey coach Joaquim Carvalho couldn't hold back his anger at the dismissive treatment meted out to his boys after their Asia Cup triumph. "The cricketers deserve the cash awards, no doubt, but should not hockey players be treated in the same manner?" he said. A coach and four players from Karnataka threatened to go on hunger strike in protest. Even the usually mild Viswanathan Anand—after winning the World Championship title in Mexico, barely days after India's T20 triumph—wondered what kind of welcome he would get on his return. "Yes, I heard about it (the welcome given to the cricket team). It would be interesting to see what kind of reception I get when I come to India," he reportedly said. Subsequently, a rousing yet chaotic reception was made ready for a true champion.

Just as success bred conflicts, even failure had its fall-outs. India's forgettable stint at the ICC World Cup in West Indies was followed by coach